

PALACE ON WHEELS

Travelling in the style of a Maharaja through India's most evocative destinations is one of the most luxurious railway experiences. The Palace on Wheels, one of the world's top five luxury trains, is a reconstruction based on the personal carriages of the rulers of Rajputana and Gujarat, the Nizams of Hyderabad, and the Viceroy of India. Each carriage is named after a Princely State of Rajasthan, with interiors that reflect its history through paintings, furniture, and handicrafts.

ASPIRING TO ROYALTY

In 1982, the Indian Railways teamed up with the Rajasthan Tourism Development Cooperation to provide a luxury metre-gauge service with plush carriages that emulated the grand decor of an earlier age. In the 1990s, the service was switched to broad gauge and the accommodation was replaced with air-conditioned cabins and attached bathrooms. Still running today, the train is made up of 14 saloons, a kitchen car, two restaurants, a bar with a lounge, and four service cars. To add a further touch of royal experience, the train offers personal *khidmatgars* (attendants), who are available to serve guests around the clock.